

Salesforce Dreamforce and HubSpot Partner Conversations; Pre-Quiet Period Roundup

Enterprise Software

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Agenda

Dreamforce Quotes

HubSpot Quotes

Pre-Quiet Period Roundup

Dreamforce: Core CRM Spend Has Come Off the Sidelines

- [SI Contact]: "From last year through about May or June of this year, customers were in a status-quo holding pattern. They were really trying to figure out if AI was going to make a big difference in the way they work with SaaS platforms like Salesforce, Workday, ServiceNow, NetSuite. We saw a trend of holding back on budgets and new strategic opportunities; mainly lights-on maintenance work. **Around May or June of this year we saw the air clearing. What we saw from our customers is: I think Salesforce is going to stay, the 'SaaS apocalypse' is not a real thing. We have tried vibe coding some of these applications in CRM and it's not as robust as Salesforce. So let's bring some of those projects back, let's continue investing in Salesforce.** The last three to four months have been a major uptick in the Salesforce business, and last year through June was flat."
- [SI Contact]: "**This uptick in the pipeline that I've seen in the last three to four months is: I just need a robust CRM.** I still can't manage my opportunities in a way that I have a handle on my best clients, my repeat customers, my high-value clients, or who's churning versus who is not. **So a lot of what we see coming back is still core digital transformation.**"
- [SI Contact]: "[Is your Salesforce business accelerating versus a year ago?] **Oh, it is accelerating.** [What's driving it?] **Existing customers moving toward innovation and AI.**"
- [SI Contact]: "Most customers are done with the basic cloud implementation, like Sales Cloud, Service Cloud. **Everybody's exploring Data Cloud and Agentforce now. That is the focus.**"

Dreamforce: The Anthropic Partnership Is the Main Story, Though it is Early

- [SI Contact]: ***"I love the idea of what it could do, but I'm not impressed by what they showed.*** What they were showing was just gimmicky stuff. ***I think the power lies in what they can do with it."***
- [SI Contact]: ***"I love what they're doing with Claude and Anthropic. That is very powerful. In my head, now I have light at the end of the tunnel. I can see what this reasoning layer can actually do, because the Agentforce reasoning engine was kind of an unclear system. This Anthropic reasoning engine is real.*** But it has to have the authority and autonomy to override and take actions."
- [SI Contact]: "There's just a general hype. ***Dario and Benioff talking side by side like partners brings a lot of confidence back to the ecosystem*** vs. the prior thinking that Anthropic is working against Salesforce or trying to pull users out."
- [SI Contact]: ***"I'm already working with a retail client in the UK using that exact thing before the partnership even came in.*** An AI-led full TCO, single pane of glass, for a 10+ billion-pound retail giant. ***Anthropic is connected to their entire finance system, so every business case that's been signed off is connected to the finance line item to see how much cost reduction that business case actually led to. So you can reason with it and know where the value is actually dropping or not delivering.*** That's one. And two, how do you leverage that for dormant versus active seats."
- [SI Contact]: "[Claudeforce] is not there yet because it's not running on Service. ***It's only running on Sales right now. But the next release will probably give it access to service agents."***
- [SI Contact]: "They're revolutionary. Once you start introducing very high-powered enterprise platforms and making them able to do this, it's definitely going to increase what you can do. ***I think they've been really smart with that. They realize not everything needs to be monopolized on Salesforce, but rather a cohesive ecosystem where they can leverage the power of these other platforms and bring more clients to still put their data within."***

Dreamforce: It is Unclear What Claudeforce Costs

- [SI Contact]: "***I honestly don't know Claudeforce; it's so new.*** Yesterday they said come over and we'll turn on Claudeforce for your org, just bring your org number. ***But it's not going to be free.*** Customers are going to pay some inferencing cost to Claude. ***A lot of people are worried that clients will push back because now they double-pay, once to Salesforce and again to Claude.*** But I think that's going to stick around in the economy. We'll see at the end of the year when they really look at their Claude invoice and their Salesforce renewal."
- [SI Contact]: "***If a client sees that outreach through a digital BDR with Claudeforce is actually helping build pipeline, then more money is fine. If it's not helping and they're paying 1.5x what they used to pay a human BDR, they will cut back.*** I haven't come across clients that are at that decision point yet."
- [SI Contact]: "They asked me what I think the price point is going to be for calculating consumption economics. ***In six months new models will come out that will consume ten times more credits. How am I supposed to predict this?***"
- [SI Contact]: "***You get X credits that includes how you use these two things. And is there an exchange rate? Does that exchange rate change? I don't think even they know. I don't know what the next six months is. The client is asking me what they should do, and I don't know what it will mean in six months.***"

Dreamforce: Headless and the Seat Growth Dynamics

- [SI Contact]: "***There is seat trimming going on.*** Parker Harris talked a few years back about 'why even log into Salesforce', and that's happening now, with Headless. ***So I think over the next ten years the UI will die.*** Slowly, over time, we will talk to agents or type to agents, and agents will get the work done or bring the information forward. ***There will be a slow erosion of seats. That's written on the wall. However, as seats decline, inferencing costs go up.***"
- [SI Contact]: "***If seats are trimming, we are not seeing contract values technically declining, because they are pushing Data 360, they are pushing Agentforce, they're still seeing consolidation.*** A lot of folks I talk to are worried about whether Salesforce revenue is going to erode over time. ***I don't think so.*** Core CRM and core services continue to stay there and build on top. ***Human seats might decline and will continue to decline, that's just a general trend in the SaaS industry. But agent seats are going to continue. Agents still need logins, and different agents need different logins.***"
- [SI Contact]: "***I don't think it's going to be a one-to-one variation, like we're using headless now so seats go down.*** Strategically, companies will look at how their stack is set up, what they want to take outside the platform and what they want to keep on core CRM. ***But I wouldn't say consumption through headless goes up and seats go down. I think there's going to be more opportunity for Salesforce to take market share in their core seat products, because they still need core CRM, that's the whole foundation. They still need all the underlying metadata that Salesforce as a product holds.***"
- [SI Contact]: "***Customers don't want to be in a siloed UI. They want headless 360 where everything the customer wants to see is available.*** Data 360: anything, any time, the entire data should be analytic. ***This is the demand, this is the need of the future.***"
- [SI Contact]: "[On headless offsetting seat growth] ***I think the jury's out. It's too early to predict that.***"
- [SI Contact]: "Nowadays Salesforce is a back-end engine. ***People want to work in the Copilot: 'give me my opportunities'; they don't want to log into Salesforce.*** Users look at a holistic journey. They don't want to log into four or five systems. Let's say with MCP I connect everything into one. ***So Salesforce will eventually become the back end.***"

Dreamforce: Why the Back-End Shift May Not Hurt Salesforce

- [SI Contact]: "[Does it worry you that the user never logs into Salesforce?] **No, because ultimately the implementation still has to be in Salesforce.** The only thing is whether I'm calling Salesforce APIs or connecting via MCP. **But core implementation I have to do is in Salesforce.** If I have a sales process, opportunity goes from stage one to stage four, to won and lost, I have to build that process. **The only difference is my user doesn't have to log into Salesforce.** They type 'give me the top five leads from this customer,' and it goes into Salesforce and finds it."
- [SI Contact]: "If you're looking at core opportunity information, you can API it out. But think about a service agent; a ticket created by a field service person, routed from a manager to a scheduler to the person actually running the van. **The logic of the ticket, the complexity of the information and the decision rules are all in Salesforce. You can't ETL all of that out. That's where headless comes into play, because headless pulls all of that logic, the workflow, the decision making, the governance, who has approval authority on those tickets.**"
- [SI Contact]: "[On external consumer agents flooding inbound channels] **If it's an external agent, Salesforce still makes money on inferencing, because whatever answer that agent is giving to the other agent, Salesforce is making money through tokens.** Is it going to reduce Salesforce spend or erode their revenue? I don't think so. They will still need the core CRM data, the customer data, the product data. **It's going to generate lots more quotes, which might actually end up meaning more revenue for Salesforce.**"

Dreamforce: Agentforce Adoption Still Early

- [SI Contact]: "***On Agentforce, we still haven't seen a big continued interest in a big way.*** Things are happening, they continue to experiment with it, simple use cases. ***But most of my clients have been building around Salesforce, with Salesforce data, not with Agentforce.***"
- [SI Contact]: "***Most of my clients are experimenting with having one to two agents.*** We have not got to the point where my clients are running very complicated multi-tier agents."
- [SI Contact]: "[Are most enterprises ready to use this stuff?] ***No. Not even close.***"
- [CRM Ecosystem Contact]: "I don't have a whole lot of experience with Agentforce at all. We work with a lot of enterprises that have Salesforce implemented throughout the organization, and ***I'm realizing I don't know anyone that actually does Agentforce.***"
- [CRM Ecosystem Contact]: "***I hear a lot that it's a lot of pre-production. We've tried it out, but does it go anywhere?*** Not enough money, time and investment to build all these great experiences that there should be. ***I just haven't seen it in practice.***"
- [SI Contact]: "[On in-production Agentforce implementations beyond the basic contact-center use cases, versus a year ago] ***It's definitely increasing.***"
- [SI Contact]: "***Customers have started rolling out into production.***"
- [SI Contact]: "***I think all the customers are slowly getting into production.***"

Dreamforce: Data Readiness Is Still the Binding Constraint

- [SI Contact]: "***We are seeing a massive amount of data foundation work that needs to be done for tomorrow's agents to run successfully.*** Claudeforce or Alforce or Data 360 or headless is only going to help an end customer stand up an agent easier. ***But as soon as they become complex agents and complex use cases, the agent doesn't perform well because of bad data. A lot of the time.***"
- [SI Contact]: "***Right now that system of record is less productive because it has less than sixty percent accuracy. That's an average. No one trusts the pipeline.*** Our own CRM is [a mess] as well. I can't make any report and say it's meaningful. ***How many people actually go into a system and update 'this is my opportunity'?*** Reps sandbag opportunities because they don't want to show leadership what they're working on, or their targets will go up. So they move it only at the last minute. ***It's inaccurate data. That's never going to change, which means agents working off that data will never be able to do anything more.***"
- [SI Contact]: "I had a customer yesterday saying ***they've been working on customer identity for eight years and still haven't figured it out.*** They're a travel and hospitality company just trying to uniquely identify you versus me. ***As much as we think customers have gone from maturity level one to two to three, a lot of enterprise customers still don't know their high-value customers.*** They haven't created personification around those customers. They still haven't figured out the next best action."
- [SI Contact]: "***Data 360 is very highly coupled.*** They pay for inferencing and they pay for the Data 360 license. Foundations are given to them free, but foundation is just an object layer. On top of it they're paying for Data 360 and then paying for Agentforce. ***So some of it is: does this really still make sense? Am I getting the ROI? Is Agentforce actually giving me information that's valuable, or is it giving me half responses?*** Summarizing, I'd say data readiness, governance, access to data; and some of that is product issues."
- [SI Contact]: "That's where Data 360 comes into the picture. ***It's a zero-copy format, you can have one single 360-degree view of the customer, and on top of it your Agentforce will ground on those things.***"

Dreamforce: Flex Credits, Swaps and Consumption Economics

- [SI Contact]: "**We still see free flex credits being given to clients to experiment and test it out. The expectation is that once you have Agentforce, once you implement Data 360, you'd continue to double down on it, have more agents, and so you'd start paying me.** What we have seen is three-year contracts where they've slid in or added Agentforce and Data 360 licensing cost and sold it through demos of how a business can benefit from agents."
- [SI Contact]: "**There are clauses in the contract where you can swap.** If they're not using Agentforce and they have paid, they can say: sorry, your agents are not performing to my expectations, **I would like to swap those flex credits on Data 360 and Agentforce for more seats. Give me seats.** And I have a client basically saying **'I don't want Agentforce. I did sign up for Agentforce, it did not work for me in the way that I thought, I'd like to swap that license for fees.'**"
- [SI Contact]: "**We're going back to the old days when we had software that ran on overages.** You get the client onboarded, they increase adoption, and you send them a bill."
- [SI Contact]: "I published a paper about **a complete redesign of revenue architecture for consumption-monetized products versus standard subscription. Your account executive needs to be incentivized very differently to increase adoption, which means how you pay commission is different.** With subscription you pay them as they sign the contract. **With consumption, it's not when they sign the contract, it's how they take it to the next level.**"
- [SI Contact]: "When an agent hits Data Cloud, **it's token-based, so that consumption will be there.** They announced the licensing yesterday, so we have to see how it will work, **but they've simplified the licensing part.**"

Dreamforce: Slack as the Digital Front Office

- [SI Contact]: "**We are seeing Slack becoming a digital front office. As the UI is slowly declining, we are seeing an uplift there**, and they talked about Slackbot seeing an uptrend in the keynote."
- [SI Contact]: "What Slack might do is **become their UI**. [Is that happening yet?] **I don't have a client that is actually running bots on Slack. I've heard about clients doing it. I haven't put something together for a client of mine.** But we see that happening, and we are talking with a client about it. If I come back and talk to you in 2027, hopefully I'll have deployed users on Slackbot."
- [SI Contact]: "You don't want to log in. For T&E you can just upload your receipt and tell an agent, submit my T&E. **It has your login, it has your receipts from your Amex, it knows why you were there for a conference. That's the power of something like Slackbot, because you don't need to swivel-chair through three or four different applications.**"
- [SI Contact]: "**I have heard that Salesforce is thinking about giving Slack away for free to compete with MS Teams.** The predominant pushback from clients is: I don't want to buy Slack because I'm using Teams, I can do everything with Teams, and Teams comes with my Microsoft licensing, so why should I buy Slack? **We'll see how it all works out.**"

Dreamforce: 'Death of Software' Narratives

- [SI Contact]: "***I have one client, a major client, who says 'I'm going to vibe-code my CRM and get rid of Salesforce.'*** I told them good luck, please reach out wherever you land on that and we're happy to consult. ***I honestly don't think that's going to work for an enterprise customer with a lot of complicated decision rules. I just don't think that works.***"
- [SI Contact]: "***SMB to mid-market has a tendency to churn, but we haven't seen our customers come out of Salesforce in a meaningful way.*** I think ***HubSpot is more vulnerable***, or Pipedrive, or Zoho. ***Simpler CRM-focused apps with very simple functionality that can be vibe-coded. I honestly haven't seen [Salesforce] CRM being a target there.***"

Dreamforce: Five-Year Architectural Center of Gravity

- [SI Contact]: "**CRM, I think Salesforce will continue to rule from a front-office standpoint**, and communication through Slack; other than Teams they don't have a lot of competition there. **I think ServiceNow will continue to rule in the back end. Microsoft will continue to be your copilot for employees, probably for simple task management.** I don't think any of these core business application platforms is going away. **But we will see continued growth in that layer of data consolidation, where data is being pulled from different platforms into maybe it's Data 360, maybe it's Snowflake Cortex, maybe it's Databricks. And then there are multi-agents that are going to sit on top of it.** From a core enterprise function perspective I still see Salesforce, Oracle and NetSuite in certain areas, Workday in HRIS, ServiceNow in ITIL, Coupa in finance management. **I don't see them being ripped apart, to be honest with you.**"
- [SI Contact]: "**A lot of that [data] spend is not going to Salesforce, it's going to Bedrock or your traditional databases.** If they have two or more products on Salesforce, **we see a gravitational pull towards Data 360. If they're not, they tend to do their own thing.** It can be Snowflake, it can be S3 on AWS, it can be a different CDP platform."
- [SI Contact]: "[On losing customer service deals to AI-native startups] **I haven't come across any, in my opinion.** There are non-profits that can't spend a lot and are doing simple agentic flows on other platforms because they can't afford Service Cloud. **But if it's mid-market to enterprise, they're not worried about that much, at least in my opinion.**"

Dreamforce: Packaging Remains Fluid; Enterprise Agent Adoption Is Years Away

- [SI Contact]: "***Each customer ends up becoming custom.*** It depends on which level of customer you're talking about, what their relationship with Salesforce has been historically, there are a whole bunch of factors that go into how Salesforce positions that."
- [SI Contact]: "***It's too early for me to have an opinion [on the new packaging tiers], because it's not settled yet with clients*** and the RVPs and AEs haven't started talking to them."
- [SI Contact]: "One customer we speak to, Sales Cloud and Service Cloud licenses they already have. ***Now they are purchasing the Data Cloud and Agentforce licenses.*** With the new announcement we have to look at the bundle. ***They've simplified it, but then they change it every year or two. It's changing so fast.***"
- [SI Contact]: "***It's good enough when you ask an agent on your own [consumer] app to find you restaurants for dinner. But if it's going to do that, you need to give it permission to access your emails, that's when it becomes powerful.*** That's only working now for consumers, in the last month or so. ***When does it even flow to the enterprise? Data security, regulations, compliance. At what point will a broker say: agents, execute my trade based on the best time of day? Five years? Ten years?***"
- [SI Contact]: "[On consumer agents driving a surge of inbound to call centers] ***I haven't built one for a customer. Most of my customers aren't at a point where they even have one agent running.***"

Agenda

Dreamforce Quotes

HubSpot Quotes

Pre-Quiet Period Roundup

UNBOUND: Partner Growth and Deal Pipelines Vary as Sales Cycles Lengthen

- [HubSpot Partner]: Deal pipeline is strong and the partner is not having to conduct much prospecting as leads come through the channel from HubSpot: ***“we have a pretty good reputation - customers have been coming to us [from HubSpot] all the time.”***
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – EMEA & APAC]: On extending sales cycles, the partner commented: “it's reticence in the market. ***We're not losing deals, they're just taking more effort to close, more touch points [with C-level executives],*** waiting to see. Having worked through three recessions in my professional career, ***that's where my feeling comes from, that it's economic.***”
- [Top HubSpot Partner – EMEA]: In response to a question about the impact of macro pressures and AI confusion overhang extending sales cycles, the contact said: ***“the last few months have been really bad, really bad. A lot of indecision,*** a lot of [customers asking] “are we going to do a big technological change now?”, ***that's extending into the third quarter.”***
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – Americas]: The partner described his practice growth as in the ***20-25% range y/y*** since bottoming from a COVID peak that saw his practice grow ***75% y/y***.
- [Elite HubSpot Partner Executive]: The contact generally agreed with management's points on lengthening sales cycles due to increasing customer touch points during a typical sales process, however, he said his practice is ***“beginning to see the pushed / deals roll in.”***

UNBOUND: AI Adoption Faces Customer Hesitation and Data Privacy Constraints

- [HubSpot Partner]: “That’s my main [goal] for the next two days: ***figuring out why [my customers] aren’t using [HubSpot’s] agents. What are they all missing out on?***”
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – EMEA & APAC]: Contact cited ***macro pressures and the EU’s General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) laws*** as the primary reasons for ***lengthening sales cycles and lack of sweeping AI adoption*** amongst their customers.
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – EMEA & APAC]: “***Germany basically invented the concept of GDPR and is really strict about data privacy which slows AI adoption.*** If AI tools can’t guarantee that processed data isn’t being taken outside of the EU region, ***it’s an immediate no-go.***”
- [Top HubSpot Partner – EMEA]: “Everyone wants AI initially. ***There’s a lot more hesitation this year than last year*** as [I observe] customers saying, ***“we’re going to look at this next year.”***”

UNBOUND: Credit Pack Usage Varies by Customer and Use Case

- [HubSpot Partner]: Contact noted that customers are apprehensive about adopting credit packs because they are ***afraid of burning too many credits.***
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – Americas]: In relation to AI credit pack usage, the partner characterized the usage curve as ***a steep ramp during the initial integration*** to setup different automations and reports that ***subsequently falls off significantly before increasing again at a slower pace.***
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – Americas]: The contact noted that ***credit packs are being burned more by enterprise customers vs. SMB & mid-market.*** “we have customers with very simple needs who don’t need to do everything with AI. ***It’s more the enterprise customers who are really taking advantage of it.***”
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – Americas]: In response to a question about the usage curve for Credit Packs, the partner noted that customers may unintentionally burn a high quantum of credits when setting up contact and company record enrichment with Breeze for CRM because ***“if you don’t set it up intelligently, you’re going to burn a ton of credits*** from enriching contacts and companies you may not care about.”
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – Americas]: He subsequently noted that Customer agent and Prospecting agent burn credits at a ***“relatively consistent rate so long as their lead generation / target market aim is extremely niche.”***
- [Elite HubSpot Partner Executive]: In relation to AI Credit Packs, the contact noted that there is ***bifurcation in usage amongst ‘power-users’ and the generalist business users,*** and stated that ***“only ~10% [of customers] go way over their initial capacity, while most don’t use 5% of their credits.”***

UNBOUND: Ease of Use Supports Competitive Wins, While Product Depth Remains a Consideration

- [Elite HubSpot Partner – EMEA & APAC]: ***“HubSpot is really easy to use so adoption happens much more quickly.*** It’s one point that people make when switching over to HubSpot from Salesforce.”
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – Americas]: Although not common, the partner noted that ***migrations from Salesforce do happen occasionally*** and said that a recent ***\$1B+ retail customer with >200 locations*** approached them with the intention of ***moving to HubSpot for CRM***, expressing ***displeasure with Salesforce***.
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – Americas]: In the SMB / mid-market space, the partner called out that the ***emergence of highly verticalized software offerings has made competition tougher for HubSpot across its Hubs***, as an industry agnostic player.
- [ISV Partner]: The contact indicates that, from his experience, ***a majority of fast growing HubSpot CRM customers still do consider / migrate to Salesforce when renewals approach*** as they ***“outgrow it and are advised not to wait until they’re too big to rip and replace.”***
- [ISV Partner]: The partner acknowledged the trend in tech stack consolidation but noted that, at the end of the day, he has observed customers achieving ***optimal results when using category leading products for given needs*** like using ***Salesforce for CRM and HubSpot for marketing intelligence***.
- [Elite HubSpot Partner Executive]: The contact described HubSpot as a ***less complex and more user-friendly CRM vs. Salesforce*** as HubSpot is primarily an ***organic, natively built platform*** while Salesforce is ***“a bunch of tech that’s been pieced together, which creates unnecessary complexities.”***
- [Elite HubSpot Partner Executive]: That being said, the partner notes that when complex businesses weigh HubSpot vs. Salesforce, they often realize that ***HubSpot is not as robust as Salesforce in certain categories***.
- [Elite HubSpot Partner Executive]: In response to a question about potential customer migrations to Salesforce from HubSpot, the contact firmly said that ***he’s never observed any such instance*** and that a ***more common migration happens from Salesforce Marketing Hub to HubSpot after being dissatisfied with the former*** (with some customers eventually migrating to HubSpot’s CRM as well).
- [Elite HubSpot Partner Executive]: Interestingly, the contact noted that a pain point he often hears from customers is that ***Salesforce’s customizability actually results in outdated systems*** as certain customized workflows and processes ***don’t update along with the broader platform***.

UNBOUND: Multi-Hub Adoption Broadens as Integration Needs Become More Complex

- [Elite HubSpot Partner – Americas]: Contact highlighted that the biggest difference he's observed in HubSpot integrations over the years is the **increasing complexities: "there's no more simple onboardings**. As they continue to grow up market, HubSpot has got to be **more than a marketing tool** - it's got to be connected to your ERP, it's got to be connected to Salesforce, it's got to be integrated with this, migrated from here."
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – Americas]: In relation to the multi-hub expansion that HubSpot has called out as a core growth driver, the contact gave rough estimates on the Hubs that his customers were attached to: **"90% on Marketing Hub; 70% on Sales Hub; 40% on Service Hub; not a lot of adoption on Data Hub; and Revenue Hub relatively small now but seeing a very quick spike in adoption... wouldn't be surprised if 60% of customers are on it in 18 months."**
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – Americas]: "Data Hub has its applicable, unique use cases but feel that there is **software bloat for people who have Data Hub and don't use it often...** Service Hub has historically been **a challenge and is still a tough nut to crack...** Sales Hub has **grown significantly in its comparability to Salesforce over the past three years**, and so much so that we **fully transitioned to selling Sales Hub 2.5 years ago** after being a Salesforce partner alongside Marketing Hub for ~10 years."
- [Elite HubSpot Partner Executive]: In terms of Hubs that his customers have meaningfully adopted (ex-Marketing Hub) the partner called out, in order, **Sales Hub, Service Hub, and Revenue Hub**, and noted that the latter is a **"huge advancement because there was a gap in their product in terms of full [customer] life cycle."**
- [ISV Partner]: Partner described HubSpot's Revenue Hub as a **CPQ that is sufficient for simple use cases but not yet developed enough to efficiently support things like complex billing situations, geographies with different product SKUs, and region-based discounting**.
- [ISV Partner]: **"It's not usually that a HubSpot customer uses Revenue Hub and then outgrows it - it's instead from the get-go. When there's a lot of variance and complexity from the very beginning, that's when HubSpot directs customers to [CPQ specialists]."**

UNBOUND: Data Retention Backlash Has Had Limited Lasting Impact in Partner Checks

- [Top HubSpot Partner – EMEA]: In relation to the data retention episode, which was met with customer disapproval in early July, the contact noted that his customers were ***understandably very frustrated by it*** but that he's observed ***no change in HubSpot spend after the company walked it back.***
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – Americas]: Interestingly, regarding the data retention terms of service update, which was walked back due to customer backlash, the contact said: "if it had gone through, ***it would have brought a lot of value to HubSpot users. Collective data quality and context are all rising tides,*** and it ultimately would have been ***pretty valuable for the HubSpot community.***"
- [Elite HubSpot Partner – Americas]: He called out that ***"one or two clients mentioned it"*** but that there was ***no real lasting impact from the data retention episode.***

Agenda

Dreamforce Quotes

HubSpot Quotes

Pre-Quiet Period Roundup

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Microsoft

- New segment structure reflects how Microsoft operates the business. Shared infrastructure, engineering teams and GTM motions make allocating costs between Azure and M365 less meaningful. Microsoft continues to point investors toward Microsoft Cloud profitability rather than standalone Azure margins.
- M365 Commercial Cloud acceleration remains intact, with AI consumption creating a second monetization layer. Growth is expected to benefit from E5 / E7 upgrades and Copilot adoption, while newer agentic workloads add consumption revenue on top of the existing per-user subscription model.

ServiceNow

- AI ACV remains predominantly SKU upgrade-driven, with consumption still early. Most of the \$1B+ in AI ACV reflects the ~30% price uplift from moving to Pro Plus / Prime. Upgrades include a finite pool of Assists sized to last ~1.5-2 years, a deliberate design to address CIO concerns around unpredictable budgets; customers running low on Assists today are replenishing them in part through seat expansion and cross-product attach (Assists are fungible across products) rather than standalone Assist packs.
- On track to exceed the raised \$1.5B+ CY26 AI ACV target. The company crossed \$1B at the end of 2Q; that figure is cumulative ACV rather than net new in 1H, and Moveworks contributed north of \$100M of the 1H increase. Monetization from L1 specialists and voice AI in customer service, launching in 2H, is expected to be more of a 2027 story as customers burn down their allotments and repurchase.

Snowflake

- AI becoming a more meaningful growth driver. AI contributed roughly half of the F2Q beat, with CoCo the most meaningful contributor to the prior increase in the 2Q-4Q outlook. AI was also the largest driver of product revenue growth accelerating from 34% in 1Q to 37% in 2Q.
- Core migration opportunity remains substantial. Snowflake continues to see migrations throughout the customer lifecycle and believes it remains early in the overall migration cycle. FY26 Global 2000 customers averaged ~\$2.4M of spend versus ~\$34M for the company's top 25 product revenue customers, signifying the upside opportunity for monetization.

Pre-Quiet Period Roundup

Datadog

- Core growth remains broad based. Non-AI business has accelerated for four consecutive quarters, with strength across products, customer spend bands, and geographies. Management cited healthy cloud / modernization demand, improving execution and easier y/y comps.
- Limited incremental color on large customer behavior. Management reiterated the lower consumption trends from its largest customer in 2Q26, highlighting that the customer leverages 17 products.

Workday

- Workday MCP/ Workday through AI front-door-of-choice vs. Data Cloud. The company framed the former as paths for agents to surface Workday via external interfaces while keeping the core data and context within Workday, as compared to the latter which opens HR and finance data to warehouse environments; the expectation is for both Data Cloud and MCP to reach general availability around Rising.
- New subscription revenue diversified amongst new & existing customers; strong opportunities in the mid-market. Existing customers contribute roughly 60% of incremental subscription revenue and new customers about 40%; medium-sized enterprises contribute 60%+ of incremental new-business bookings (significant overlap with international) supporting management's push for more predictable new-customer growth.

Pre-Quiet Period Roundup

CoreWeave

- Capacity continues to come forward. CoreWeave raised its active power outlook to 1.85 GW from 1.7 GW, which the company characterized as a pull-forward from 2027 rather than incremental long term capacity. Since giving its prior 2027 outlook, the company said business developments have been “positively incremental.”
- Pricing remains favorable. New-contract pricing is running ~25% higher on an apples-to-apples GPU SKU basis, driven primarily by strong demand and improving customer ROI as workloads shift toward inference, with higher component costs also contributing. CoreWeave said 3Q deal flow continues to support the previously discussed 5-10 pts of margin expansion.
- Shorter contracts broaden the customer opportunity. New financing structures allow CoreWeave to support more 2-3 year contracts rather than requiring 5-year commitments, which the company sees as an important unlock for customer diversification. Even under a downside renewal scenario, CoreWeave estimates levered IRRs remain in the low 50%.
- Operating leverage is beginning to show. Profitability upside reflected operating efficiencies as the business scales, although timing between capacity costs and GPU monetization can create quarterly volatility. CoreWeave also expects some seasonality in 2027 and will provide a fuller 2027 update after year-end.

Twilio

- Messaging remains the key revenue driver, with recent strength broad-based. Messaging is now ~60% of revenue and grew 18% ex-carrier fees in both Q1 and Q2. Recent upside was not driven by a single use case or one-time factor, with strength across verticals, U.S. volumes, marketing, authentication and notifications.
- Revenue visibility remains inherently variable despite larger-customer commitments. Twilio models its top ~1,000 accounts and larger customers typically have 1-3 year minimum commitments, but actual usage remains the key driver. The company continues to guide conservatively given the transactional nature of messaging and does not view recent 5%+ quarterly beats as the new normal.

Pre-Quiet Period Roundup

Dynatrace

- Conversion of 2H renewal cohorts underpin assumption of anticipated NRR step-up. ARR dollars up for renewal or reset are 50% higher y/y in FY27, with ~70% concentrated in 2H as three DPS cohorts enter anniversary or renewal discussions; consumption growth above 20% is running ahead of ARR growth, with the company expecting that gap to close gradually through higher commitments, and drive TTM NRR higher from current 110% level.
- Logs consumption a key watchpoint despite relatively low contribution to current ARR. Annualized logs consumption is approaching \$200M, after crossing \$100M two quarters earlier, as the company is encouraging customers to trial logs inside existing DPS commitments and then expand usage.
- Sales execution is improving beyond individual large deals. TTM net-new ARR growth reached +17% in 1Q versus +12% in 4Q and +5% in 3Q; average land size remained above \$200K excluding an eight-figure deal, while end-to-end observability sales and expanded strategic-account coverage support growth, although deal timing still affects quarterly comparisons.

Akamai

- 3Q CIS growth likely to land softer on timing of shipments. Impacts from shipment delays mentioned on the 2Q call could potentially leave 3Q CIS revenue growth below the 40% level (vs. consensus of +42% y/y) before large-committed contracts begin ramping in 4Q, making deployment timing the main near-term variable; the company illustratively described the “at least 50%” CIS growth framework in FY26 as dependent on deliveries, while emphasizing that timing changes quarterly revenue rather than the underlying contracts.
- Management preference remains long-term take-or-pay; current deal mix represents slightly inferior margins vs. longer-term range. Large, committed GPU deals generate closer to \$0.50 of ARR per dollar of capex, with up to three-year payback periods vs. 12–18 months at the favorable end of hourly GPU economics; management prefers multi-year revenue visibility, and the current deal mix sits nearer the lower end of the discussed 25–35% margin range.

Pre-Quiet Period Roundup

Paycom

- 4-6% y/y growth in Payroll and HSD y/y growth in HCM represent strong industry reference points. The company notes that share gains and international expansion will be the contributors to Paycom's incremental growth opportunity beyond industry growth rates. Paycom's sweet spot in terms of customer size remains approximately 50–1,000 employees, while international coverage gaps that previously excluded Paycom from larger deals have largely been addressed.
- IWant AI automation product included in base module subscriptions creates headwind for near-term margins while hardware refreshes and other critical IT spend remain longer-term margin costs. Management prioritized full adoption of its flagship AI product, with returns envisioned via customer usage and internal efficiency, which we view as a near-term margin headwind; management cited \$100M of GPU spending in the prior year and described infrastructure and power as the relevant gross margin costs, while developer headcount reductions offer scope to reduce R&D spending relative to revenue.

Monday.com

- Customer-acquisition weakness remains the main drag on FY26 growth. The company described continued funnel deterioration since May 2025 and further weakness embedded in guidance; sales reorganization in relation to the 20% RIF announced in July adds disruption but represents a smaller contributor to the growth algorithm.
- Work management still contributes vast majority of ARR. At roughly 88% of ARR, monday.com's work management platform continues to dominate share of ARR while CRM tracks to ~10% with other product areas representing the small balance; customers above \$50k in ARR account for 43% of total ARR and are growing faster than smaller accounts, supporting the shift in sales resources toward larger customers and installed-base expansion.

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